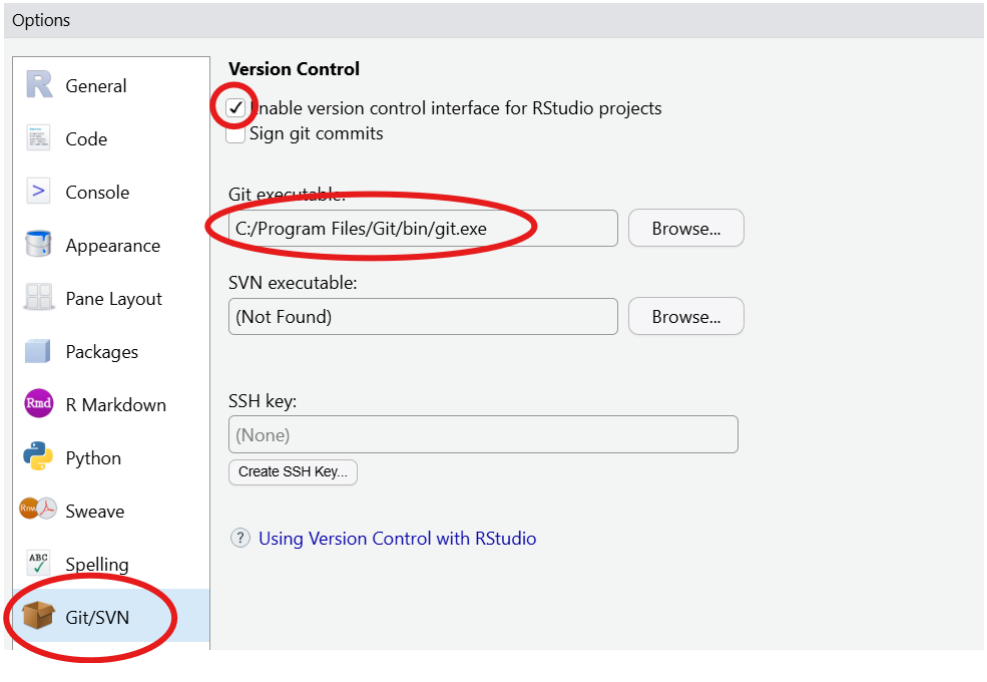
Supplementary material: work with RStudio

RStudio has a Git tab that lets you commit, push, and pull while you work on your R code. This exercise uses your `my_test_repo` repository.

Step 0. Prerequisites (only the first time)

- Install R (https://cran.r-project.org/) and RStudio (https://posit.co/download/rstudio-desktop/)
- Download and install Git (https://git-scm.com/install/). RStudio does not use the Git that comes with GitHub Desktop, so Git needs to be installed separately
- In RStudio, go to Tools --> Global Options... --> Git/SVN
  - Tick “Enable version control interface for RStudio projects”
  - Check that “Git executable” shows a path (e.g., C:/Program Files/Git/bin/git.exe on Windows, /usr/bin/git on Mac). If it is empty, click “Browse...” and select it

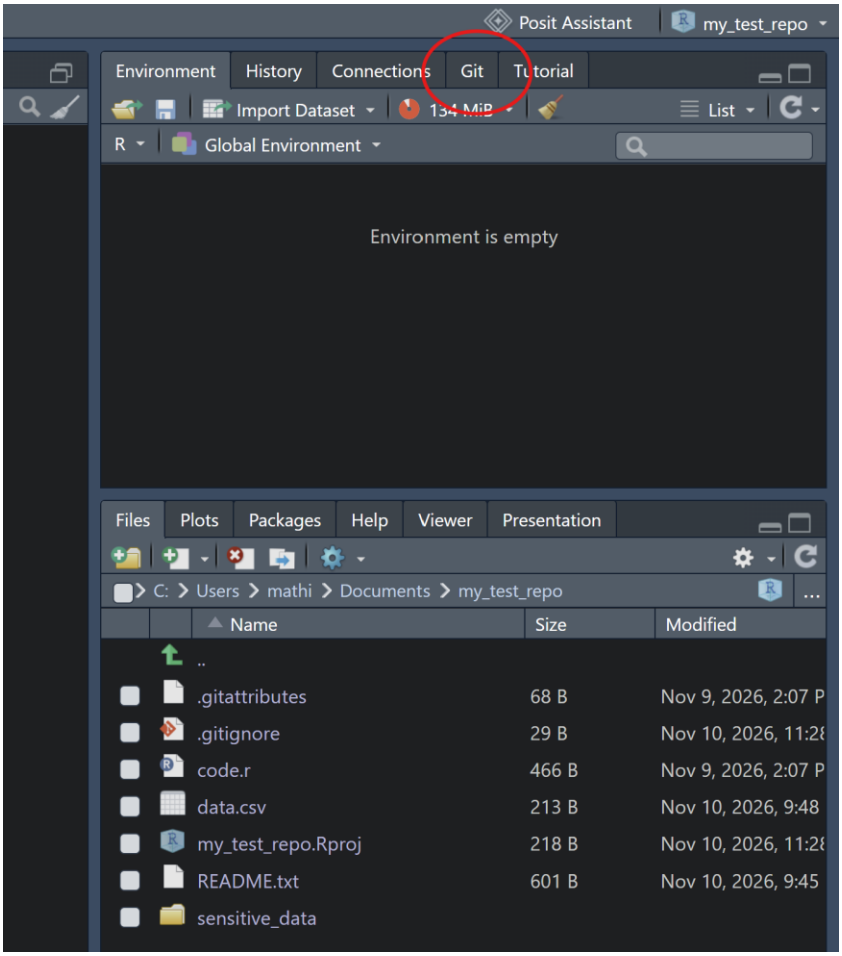


- Restart RStudio
- Note: Git uses the name and email you configured in GitHub Desktop, so you do not need to configure them again.

Step 1. Create an RStudio project in your repository

- In RStudio, go to File --> New Project... --> Existing Directory

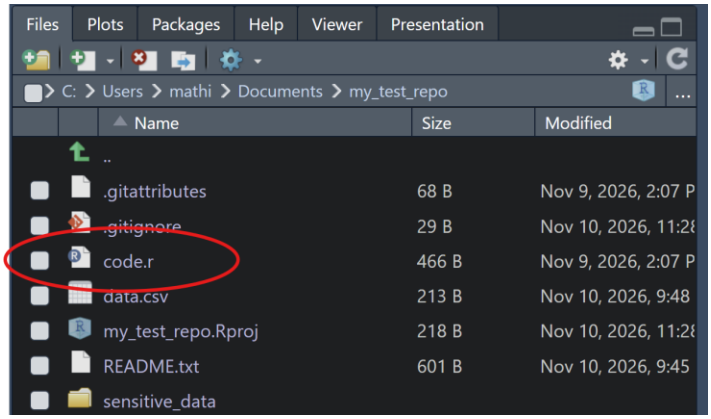
- Click “Browse…” and select your `my_test_repo` folder, then click “Create Project”
- RStudio opens the project. A “Git” tab appears in the top-right panel



RStudio created two things in your folder: a file `my_test_repo.Rproj` (double-click on it to reopen the project later) and a hidden folder `.Rproj.user`, which it added to `.gitignore` so it is not tracked. The file `.gitignore` specifies which files are considered by GitHub and which ones are not. Because it does not make sense to track `.Rproj.user`, which only contains personal settings for your computer (open tabs, temporary files), RStudio excludes it automatically. You can use `.gitignore` in the same way to keep sensitive data out of your repository: see the supplementary material “Keep sensitive data out of Git with .gitignore”.

Step 2. Run the code

- In the Files panel (bottom right), click on `code.r` to open it in RStudio



- Click “Source” (top right of the script) to run the whole script



Because you work in an RStudio project, the working directory is automatically your repository folder: `read.csv(“data.csv”)` finds the data without setting any path.

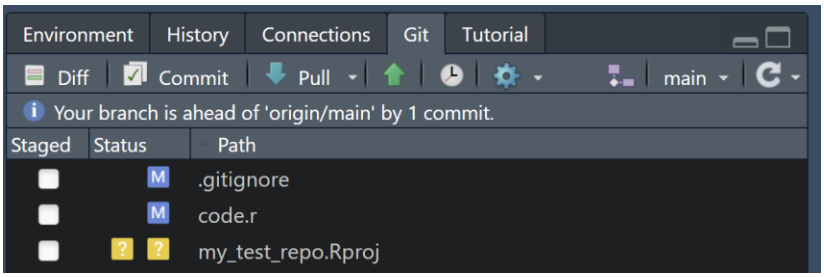
Step 3. Edit the code

- Add the following lines at the end of `code.r`, and save (Ctrl+S / Cmd+S):

```
# Number of respondents by gender

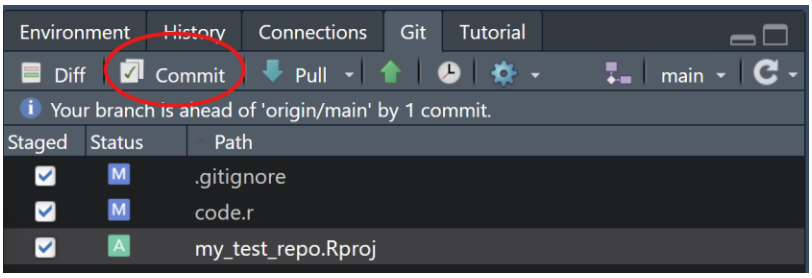
table(data$gender)
```

- In the Git tab, `code.r` appears with an “M” (modified)

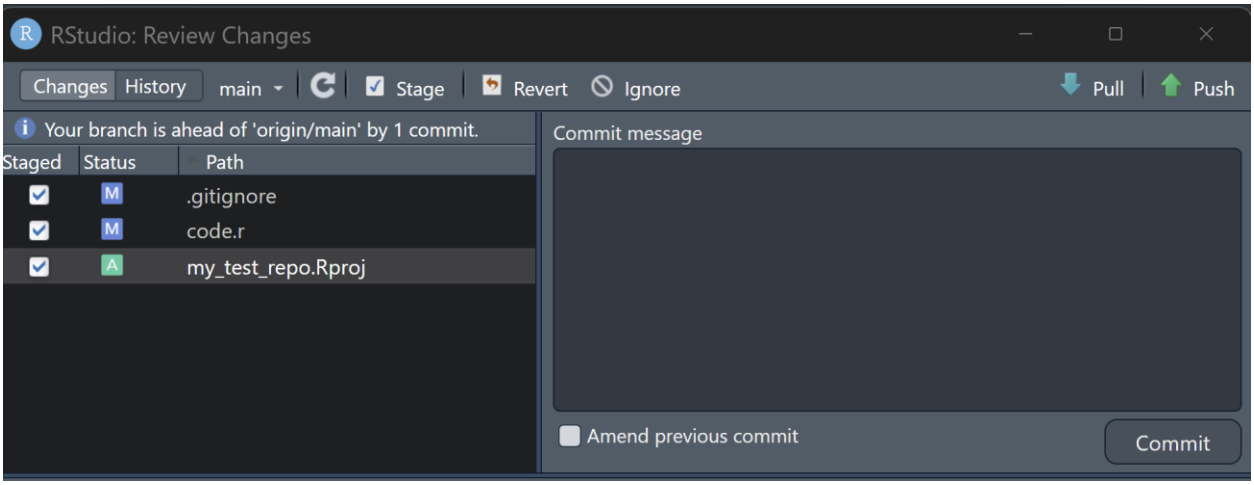


Step 4. Add, commit, and push

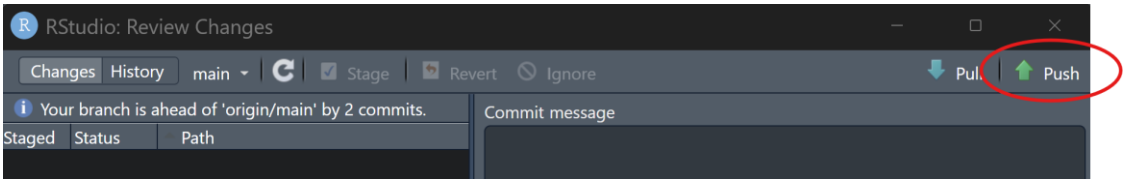
- In the Git tab, tick the “Staged” box next to `code.r`, `.gitignore`, and `my_test_repo.Rproj` (= it adds these files to the next commit we want to make)
- Click “Commit”. A window opens: you see what changed in each file (removed lines in red, added lines in green)



- Write a message (e.g., “Add table by gender”) and click “Commit”, then “Close”



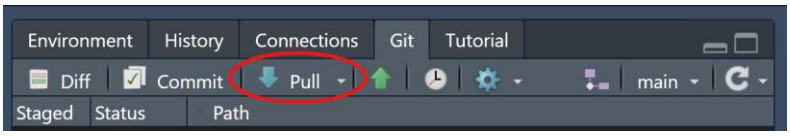
- Click “Push” (green arrow pointing up), and then "Close". Changes are now online



Note: If RStudio asks for a username and password when you push, close the window and push from GitHub Desktop instead (“Push origin”). Your commit made in RStudio is already there.

Step 5. Pull changes

- When you start working, click “Pull” (blue arrow pointing down) in the Git tab to get the latest version from GitHub



The “History” button (clock icon) in the Git tab shows all past commits, as in the “History” tab of GitHub Desktop.